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MY POWAI

Volume No. 14 Issue No. 01 Mumbai September 2025

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Dear friends

This month, My Powai completes 12 wonderful years, a journey made possible only because of your constant support and encouragement. A heartfelt thank you to each one of our readers, contributors, and well-wishers for being part of this story.

In this special anniversary issue, we bring you extensive coverage of Independence Day celebrations across Powai, capturing the pride and patriotism of our community. Food lovers can look forward to Sherry Bhatnagar's exploration of Odisha's unique culinary delights, flavours rarely found on our plates. With the festive season tempting us with sweets, our nutritionist shares smart tips to enjoy them without letting sugar levels spike.

On the finance page, Immediate Annuity is explained as an ideal choice for those seeking a stress-free retirement. And not to miss, our astrology section with predictions that might just guide your month ahead. Of course, our local news pages continue to keep you abreast of everything that matters in and around Powai. Up next: a special feature on Ganesh Festival celebrations across Powai.

Thank you once again for walking with us through these 12 enriching years. Here's to many more together.

Warm regards,

Mahesh Kutty
(Editor)

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Need to preserve bird habitat in Powai.



D.P.K. Udas

Powai is habitat to many species of birds.

They are staying here for generations together.

The presence of greenery and waterbodies makes this place an ideal spot for birds to stay.

The proximity to Powai Hills, Sanjay Gandhi National Park and presence of the Powai Lake makes it apt environment for birds to stay.

Says Mr. Ashok Someshwar of Symphony Soc. that there are following 21 species of birds seen in the Powai area which he has captured in his camera.



1. Coppersmith Barbet
2. Golden Oriole
3. Ashy Drongo.
4. Oriental Magpie Robin
5. Rose Ringed Parakeet
6. Common Mynah
7. Asian Koel (Female)
8. Red Vented Bulbul
9. Black Kite
10. Indian Paradise Flycatcher
11. Purple Rumped Sunbird
12. Common House Sparrow (Female)
13. Scaly Breasted Munia
14. Red Whiskered Bulbul
15. Common Tailor bird
16. Spot Breasted Fan Tail
17. Ashy Prinia
18. White Breasted Waterhen
19. Large Billed Crow
20. Alexandrine Parakeet
21 Asian Koel (Male)



Now most of the skyscrapers have come up in Powai area in the last 25 years and we have invaded their space.

Says, Mr. Madhav Kulkarni of Planet Positive People that certain steps can be taken to preserve this bird habitat.

- Place water pots in window sills.
- Erect bird shelters in gardens
- Create Miyawaki Forest which is ideal for birds
- Safety of birds to be ensured.

They have been encouraging young brigade by distributing tree samplings so that they can plant and nurture.

Ms. Pooja Chhajed has been conducting quiz for children so that awareness increases about the environment.

What the Government has been doing?

- Certain areas are designated as "Bird Sanctuary"

The new construction is not allowed in such places.
The complete silence zone is maintained.
The use of air gun and shooting of birds is not allowed.

- Medical care to the injured birds

If you come across any injured bird then report to the" forest department "and they will do the needful. There are Government Veterinary hospitals
1 Bai Sakarbai Dinshaw Petit Hospital for Animals.
2 Ratan Tata small animal hospital
3 All India Institute of Physical Medicine & Rehabilitation. (AIIPMR)

The name of AIIPMR is featuring here as they developed artificial foot for Flamingo. This is first time in the World.

As you know flamingo is migratory bird. Its leg got in tangled into fishing net. The bird watchers took him to forest department. Their Vet had to amput the leg.

Then Prof.Saraf of AIIPMR got into action and developed artificial foot. It was a challenge as material used for human foot (Jaipur Foot) was not suitable as it became very heavy. They then used carbon fiber used in manufacture of aeroplane parts & F1 racing cars.

The experiment worked and flamingo could fly again.

As per ebird.org at IIT, Mumbai there are 191 bird watchers who are actively observing them.

There are new species sighted every month making us believe that may be birds are moving towards Powai.

(The author is long time resident of Powai. He takes up civic issues with the authorities. He has been instrumental in improving illumination in the area, zebra crossings , garbage removal etc.)



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HFS MUN XIV: shaping tomorrow's diplomats, today



The 14th edition of HFS Model United Nations marked a remarkable milestone in the legacy of one of Mumbai's most prestigious MUN conferences. Hosted at the elegant Meluha The Fern Hotel in Powai, the conference welcomed a vibrant delegation of approximately 200 student delegates – all poised to immerse themselves in global policy-making, negotiation and diplomacy.

The conference commenced amidst much grandeur with a formal Opening Ceremony inspired by the gravitas of the United Nations. The occasion was graced by Ms. Komal Hiranandani from the Board of Trustees of the Hiranandani Group, alongside His Excellency Mr. Cheong Ming Foong, Consul General of Singapore, who delivered an insightful keynote address underscoring the relevance of dialogue, peace, and cooperation in the 21st century. As always, it was a pleasure to have our Head of School, Mrs Kalyani Patnaik, deliver both the Opening and Closing speeches, where she emphasised that the design of diplomacy must rest on three core pillars — empathy, strategy, and innovation. Being an innovative and compassionate educational strategist, she could keenly feel the pulse of today's youth and thus eloquently guide the young delegates and learners who came from top schools across Mumbai.

Over the course of three days, delegates participated in six meticulously curated committees simulating real-life UN bodies — the Indian Crisis Cabinet (ICC), Economic and Financial Affairs Council (ECOFIN), United Nations General Assembly (UNGA), United Nations Security Council (UNSC), Disarmament and International Security Committee (DISEC) and United Nations Human Rights Council (UNHRC). Under strict formal procedure, students displayed impressive research, negotiation, and public speaking skills. Debate and discussion culminated in the drafting and passing of multiple resolutions grounded in realism, originality and responsibility.



The Closing Ceremony was a befitting finale to the intellectual rigour and spirited diplomacy witnessed across all committees. The ceremony was honoured by the presence of Mrs. Jayasree Ramesh, Chief Operating Officer of the Kotak Foundation, who applauded the initiative for promoting civic engagement and youth leadership, and His Excellency Mr. Le Quang Bien, Consul General of Vietnam, who praised the high calibre of debate and stressed the importance of nurturing globally aware citizens in today's interconnected era. Mrs Kalyani Patnaik once again graced the stage, offering words of wisdom that re-emphasised the value of dialogue, diplomacy, and global citizenship.



The entire meet was executed with impressive precision and passion. Kudos to the Secretariat, comprising Director General Master Atharva Shinde and Secretary-General Om Chakravarthy Rajkumar, along with a dedicated team of Under Secretaries and various Organising Committees, whose tireless efforts ensured the seamless execution of every detail.
Outstanding delegates were felicitated for their exceptional performance with Best Delegate, High Commendation and Special Mention awards — celebrating not just knowledge, but also discipline, diplomacy and leadership.

As the final gavel fell, one truth emerged — HFS MUN XIV wasn't merely a conference; it was a movement. A movement committed to shaping articulate thinkers, empathetic leaders and responsible global citizens. In a world often divided by difference, this conference stood tall as a beacon of unity, intellect and hope.

Hiranandani Foundation School, Powai, launches Sindhi Cultural Club with a vibrant inaugural celebration



Hiranandani Foundation School, Powai, added a new feather to its cultural cap on August 1, 2025, with the grand inauguration of its Sindhi Cultural Club. Conceived to promote cultural pride and awareness among students, the launch was a jubilant celebration of Sindhi heritage, marked by colour, music, tradition, and youthful enthusiasm. A key objective of the Club is to help students understand how the Sindhi language enriches Indian culture and inspires unity in diversity.

The event was held in the school's Multipurpose Room in the presence of distinguished guests – Ms. Kavita Rijwani and Ms. Sunita Rijwani Menon – and witnessed an enthusiastic turnout of students and staff. The programme commenced on a traditional note with a soulful prayer, followed by the ceremonial lighting of the lamp. A special felicitation ceremony was conducted to honour the dignitaries for their guidance and support. The Principal - Mrs Kalyani Patnaik, spoke of the culture and the legacy left behind by some legendary freedom fighters and luminaries. Dr L.H. Hiranandani, our founding father, was remembered, and his values, "Simple living and high thinking", were emphasised, giving importance to inner richness over external opulence.

Students of HFS Powai showcased the richness of Sindhi culture through an engaging cultural presentation. The audience was treated to a graceful Sindhi folk dance and a well-crafted skit that highlighted Sindhi identity, values, and traditions. Students of Grades 3, 4, and 5 infused energy into the event with their lively group performance to the popular song "Aasee Sindhi Ahyoo", meaning "We are Sindhis". The spirited rendition of the all-time classic "Dama Dam Mast Kalandar" had the audience clapping in rhythm, celebrating the vibrant spirit of Sindhi music.

Adding a heartfelt dimension to the celebrations was a short trilingual dialogue delivered by the students in Sindhi, reflecting their pride in being part of the newly launched club. It served as a delightful reminder of the deep connection between language and cultural roots. The programme concluded with the singing of the National Anthem, after which it was officially announced that the Sindhi Cultural Club will commence its regular activities from August 11, 2025.

The launch of the Sindhi Cultural Club at HFS Powai was not merely an event, but a meaningful step towards strengthening cultural identity, inclusivity, and pride among young learners. The celebration left everyone present inspired and moved, reaffirming the school's commitment to nurturing holistic, culturally aware, and proud global citizens.

National Handloom Day celebrated at Powai



Organized by IIW Inspiring Indian women, a not-for-profit company registered in India and UK, the event was initiating and executed in just 5 days. Despite being a working day and rains in the first half around 16 ladies joined to make a statement and raise concern over the plight of Weavers.

The walk was to create awareness towards the sufferings of Indian WEAVERS! They don't get the real price and the ART is dying because of Power loom Sarees selling in Cheaper price. The industrial revolution which affected the local Artisans in Bharat need aggressive awareness campaigns for survival as the next generation of the Artisans don't find this lucrative for livelihood anymore. These Handloom Sarees - the Kantha, the Paithanis, the Benarasis, the Kanjeevarams, the Madurai Silks, the Maheshwaris , the Bhagalpuris, the Pochampally, the Ikkat etc are our Art, tradition, treasure and needs to be preserved and cherished.

The girls today are attracted more to the comfortable western outfits. But these 6 yards are the most elegant and graceful on all body types. So, the ladies walked in these sarees to popularise Sari with Gen Z. Iconic Powai Lake, Mumbai was the best place as where else can it be better to flaunt the traditions than this natural surroundings in the background.

This event also led to community bonding, togetherness and flaunting the heritage, creating memories together.

Rashmi Mishra, Falgguni Oza, Mamta Mahapatra, Vijayalakshmi Chari, Ashlesa Dash. Preeti Oka, Sujata Kotian, Manju Gupta, Kamal Paratey, Olive D'Souza, Arati Saha, Shilpa Balakrishnan, ReetuParna Banerjee, Nisha Mohta, Tejal Aiya, Neslin Daisy were some of the prominent ladies who participated in this initiative. The entire event was planned under the under the guidance and mentorship of Shri Bhupendra Shah ji

IIW Inspiring Indian Women Organisation is passionate about connecting women globally and breaking stereotypes, supporting women in all possible ways be it domestic abuse or mental wellbeing or upscaling dreams and businesses.

Immediate Annuity: A simple promise of peace in retirement

Retirement is often imagined as the golden period of life—a time to rest, travel, or spend moments with loved ones. Yet, when the retirement corpus finally lands in our bank account, it can feel overwhelming. Suddenly, advice pours in from friends, family, and even our own years of half-remembered knowledge. What should we do with this hard-earned money? How do we make sure it lasts as long as we do?

This month, a recently retired couple, whom I have known for two decades, walked into my office. They already had rental income from real estate, investments in equity, and mutual funds. Yet, they were firm about wanting an annuity. Why? Because they wanted one simple thing: a guaranteed pension every month, protection for the surviving spouse, and assurance that their capital would return to the nominee. They knew that certainty brings peace of mind.

What is an Immediate Annuity?
An immediate annuity is a contract where you pay a lump sum to an insurance company, and in return, you start receiving a fixed pension almost right away—usually within a month. Think of it as converting your savings into a steady paycheck for life.

"Common Concerns Answered"



Does it make sense if I already have other investments?
Yes. Annuities add stability. Even if you have equities or property income, annuities act as a safety net—money you can always count on.

What about my spouse or dependents?
Options allow continuation of pension to the spouse and return of the initial capital to nominees. This can be especially comforting for families with dependents or differently-abled children who may need lifelong care.

Isn't the return lower than mutual funds or equities?
True, annuities don't chase high returns. Instead, they provide predictability. It's less about growth and more about peace. A promise that calms the heart

When that couple walked out of my office, their smiles said it all. They weren't chasing the highest returns—they were securing peace, dignity, and certainty.

An immediate annuity may not be flashy, but it quietly assures: "Your tomorrow is taken care of." And sometimes, that's the greatest gift retirement can bring.

- Uma Kumaravelan
Certified Financial Planner
www.oaktree.in



Pedaling towards a better future: refurbished bicycles for school children



In an inspiring step toward sustainability and social impact, a donation drive of refurbished bicycles is giving schoolchildren more than just a mode of transport—it's giving them independence, confidence, and hope.

Each donated bicycle, once discarded and forgotten, has been carefully restored to full life. This act of upcycling not only diverts waste from landfills but also embodies the principles of a circular economy, where resources are valued and reused to their fullest potential.

For the children who receive them, these bicycles are more than wheels—they are wings. Reliable mobility means students can travel to school safely and quickly, overcoming long walking distances that often drain energy and time. With easier access to education, school attendance improves, punctuality increases, and learning opportunities grow.

Beyond practicality, there is an emotional transformation. Riding their own bicycle gives children a sense of pride and independence—a tangible sign that they can shape their own journey. The ability to move freely instills self-confidence, encourages social connections, and opens doors to extracurricular activities.

The benefits reach far beyond the individual. By cycling instead of using motorized transport, children contribute to a cleaner environment, reducing carbon emissions and promoting healthier lifestyles. The community gains healthier, happier, more empowered young citizens—and the planet takes a small but important breath of relief.

This initiative is proof that small acts—like breathing new life into an old bicycle—can create ripples of positive change for education, the environment, and the human spirit.

RCCM collected 110 old unused bicycles from various societies of Mumbai suburbs, some cycles came from Pune, collected by an enthusiastic 19 year old boy. Some of the collected cycles were irreparable. Finally, 94 bicycles were refurbished and donated to Anand Laxman Chandavarkar Vidyalaya in Khanivali village of district Palghar by RCCM . This school has a strength of about 900 children and this is the second phase of donation in the school by the Club. It was a very impactful occasion for Ex-President Meena Bhasin, Project Lead Shilpy Goyal and all the accompanying Rotarians to see the lit up faces of 94 kids who received the gift of these cycles, which will make it easier for them to pursue their dream of education.

This highly impactful sustainable project has only been possible with the Support of TASNA .Tons of thanks to TASNA & team for being with RCCM in this noble cause....giving smiles of pride and confidence to these school kids.

A musical tribute to the Kapoor Khandan in Powai



Evergreen Karaoke Singing Group organised a musical evening dedicated to Bollywood songs from the legendary Kapoor Khandan. The event featured timeless melodies from the films of Raj Kapoor, Shammi Kapoor, and Shashi Kapoor. Participants, aged between 40 and 80 years, sang popular songs spanning from the 1920s to 2022. The evening saw an array of solos and duets of evergreen hits such as Aao Huzoor Tumko, Mere Tute Hue Dil Se, Aye Gulbadan, Phoolon Ki Mehak, Jane Kahan Gaye Woh Din, Ehsaan Tera Hoga Mujh Par, Tum Bin Jaaun Kahan, Dil Ke Jharokhe Se, Laaga Chunri Mein Daag, Isharon Isharon Mein, Panchi Banu Udti Phiru, Tumne Mujhe Dekha, Baar Baar Dekho, Megha Chhaye Aadhi Raat, Aajkal Tere Mere Pyar Ke, Ek Din Bik Jaayega, Aaja Aai Bahar, Yashomati Maiya Se, Pardesiyon Se Na Ankhiyan, Aasman Se Aaya Farishta, Likhe Jo Khat Tujhe, Govinda Aala Re, Dil Mein Tujhe Bithakar, and Ghungroo Ki Tarah, among many others.

The program was held at a Powai restaurant, equipped with a superior sound system, which further enhanced the charm of the evening. The Evergreen Karaoke Singing Group hosts such sessions once every month. The event was organised by Bhupendra Shah, who can be contacted at 9324662290.

— *Preeti Oka*

Independence Day celebration



Lake Pleasant, Phase 2 Lake Home



Arum-Alamanda, Nahar



Powai Kerala Samajam



Brentwood, Hiranandani Gardens

Independence Day celebration



Symphony CHS



RVSA, Raheja Vihar



Sovereign, Hiranandani Gardens

Independence Day celebration



Orchid Enclave, Nahar



Magnolia Enclave, Nahar

Independence Day celebration



Gopal Sharma International School



Synchronicity CHS

Independence Day celebration



Evening Glory, Raheja Vihar



Lakeside, Raheja Vihar



Jal Vayu Vihar, Sector B

From flag to flute: a fusion of freedom and faith

Kanakia Silicon Valley celebrated a unique blend of patriotism and devotion this August, as Independence Day and Janmashtami came together in a vibrant display of unity and culture.

The Independence Day festivities began with the flag hoisting, a moment of pride as the tricolor rose high against the morning sky. It was a poignant reminder of the sacrifices that secured India's freedom. The highlight of the occasion was the moving "Operation Sindoor" performance, a symbolic portrayal of the courage and sacrifice of India's unsung warriors. Through powerful storytelling and visual drama, the performance honored the heroes who built the India we know today.

The spirit of patriotism continued with heartfelt performances by children and adults. Skits, speeches, and songs brought alive the legacy of leaders like Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam. The passion of the community reminded everyone that freedom is not only a gift but also a responsibility to be carried forward with dignity and commitment.

From national pride, the celebrations gracefully transitioned to devotion with the arrival of Janmashtami. The Ladoo Gopal Pooja, with its abhishek and aarti, created an atmosphere of serenity and faith. Prasad was shared, and a beautifully narrated story of Krishna's childhood leelas transported the gathering to Vrindavan, where mischief and miracles continue to inspire generations. The stage then came alive once more with soulful bhajans and energetic dance performances. Both children and adults showcased their talents, blending tradition with creativity and filling the evening with joy and devotion.

What made these celebrations truly memorable was the participation of every generation. From toddlers dressed as little Krishnas to senior citizens proudly waving the tricolor, the community stood united in celebration.

By honoring freedom and faith side by side, Kanakia Silicon Valley created a celebration that was more than just an event. It became a shared memory that reinforced the strength of culture, the depth of devotion, and the pride of being one community.











Patriotism and unity shine at Jal Vayu Vihar's Independence Day



As has been the proud tradition over the years, the 79th Independence Day of our nation was celebrated with great patriotic spirit and community participation at Jal Vayu Vihar, Sector A, Powai. The celebration was held on the lush green lawns of the society, which were beautifully adorned with national flags and festive decorations that added to the sense of occasion.

On the morning of 15th August 2025, residents of Sector A, including Armed Forces veterans, senior citizens, children, and families, gathered in impressive numbers to mark this important national event. The celebrations began at 1100 hours with the formal flag hoisting ceremony.

The honours were performed by Air Commodore Prakash V Karapurkar, VSM (Retd), a highly respected member of the community. As the Tiranga was unfurled and fluttered high in the breeze, the National Anthem played in the background, stirring a sense of pride and unity among all present. The solemnity of the moment was felt deeply, as residents stood in respectful silence, reflecting on the sacrifices of our freedom fighters and the values our nation stands for.

Following the flag hoisting, the spotlight turned to the young talents of our community. Children took centre stage with vibrant and enthusiastic performances on patriotic themes. Dressed in colourful costumes, they sang, danced, and enacted short skits that celebrated the rich cultural heritage and unity of India. Their spirited performances brought smiles, applause, and a few emotional moments among the audience.

The event concluded with a round of light refreshments and informal interactions among residents, fostering camaraderie and strengthening the sense of community that Jal Vayu Vihar is known for.

This year's Independence Day celebration was not just an event — it was a heartfelt tribute to the nation and a reminder of the shared values and unity that bind us all together. Jai Hind!

Panch Smruti Celebrates 79th Independence Day with pride



The residents of Panch Smruti came together to celebrate India's 79th Independence Day with great zeal and enthusiasm. Organized by the Society's Managing Committee, the event was a vibrant display of patriotism and community spirit.

The celebrations began with the building beautifully adorned in the colours of the national flag, creating an atmosphere of pride and unity. Shri Pradip Mairale, Assistant Commissioner of Police, Sakinaka Division, attended as the Chief Guest and was warmly welcomed by a senior member of the society with a bouquet, marking the start of the celebration.

Shri Mairale hoisted the Indian National Flag, followed by the collective singing of the National Anthem. Children from the society showcased their talents through patriotic songs, and music performances.

Addressing the gathering, Shri Indianil Chatterjee, Hon. Secretary of the society, acknowledged Shri Mairale's and his team's swift action in uncovering a mephedrone (MD) manufacturing unit in Sakinaka, linked to a multi-state narcotic drug racket. He stated that such courageous and decisive action not only stops crime but also strengthens community trust and ensures public safety. Shri Chatterjee urged for similar proactive measures to safeguard residents from incidents such as eve-teasing, chain snatching, and hooliganism in and around the Panch Shrishti Complex.

In his speech, Shri Mairale outlined Mumbai Police's three major focus areas - 1.Taking action against narcotic drug peddlers and dismantling the root networks. 2. Safeguarding women and 3. Tackling and curbing cybercrime.

He urged all residents to remain vigilant and share any leads directly with him and his team for prompt action. He further encouraged residents to approach him personally if they ever face delays or lack of response, assuring decisive measures against criminal elements in and around the Panch Shrishti Complex.

ACP, Shri Pradip Mairale honoured the Society warriors with a token of appreciation for their dedication and service to Panch Smruti Society and its residents.

The event concluded with a series of fun games and activities for children, parents, and elders, followed by a spontaneous community lunch. The Independence Day celebrations at Panch Smruti stood as a true reflection of the community's commitment to unity, peace, and responsible citizenship.

To feed or not to feed?



Chaarvi Athawale

Cries of protest met the Supreme Court this month. After ordering stray dogs across Delhi to be rounded up and moved to shelters, the court faced backlash from dog lovers and animal rights activists. On Friday, it backtracked, directing that dogs be sterilised before being released back to their territories. The ruling may have calmed tempers for now, but it leaves behind a larger, thornier debate: how should cities manage their stray populations without sacrificing either public safety or compassion?



To gain a clearer picture, I spoke with members of Feed the Soul, a citizen-led collective in Powai. A grassroots movement birthed out of love for animals, the group has, over several years, put together informal systems to care for strays. Their perspective sheds light on how one community has approached the issue.

About the Collective

According to Sunita, one of the founding members, the group has around 500 dogs under care, fed twice a day through both volunteers and paid feeders. "We do everything from sterilizations and vaccinations to burials," she says. "We've also rescued abandoned pet breeds, placed them in foster care, and facilitated adoptions."

Feeding is not just about nourishment; it is the backbone of the collective's sterilization efforts. Consistent feeding allows the dogs to be monitored and treated safely. "If feeding doesn't happen, neither sterilization nor follow-up care is possible. The feeders are the conduit that makes every other intervention feasible," Sunita notes.

This focus on feeding also opens the door to innovation. Sunita explains how she recycles restaurant waste, rice and chicken, for the strays, while preventing food from being thrown.

But the work is not without its toll. "Imagine the money that goes in," Sunita remarks. "We're not an NGO. Every rupee comes from personal contributions."

Sterilization as the Cornerstone

One of the most debated issues surrounding strays is their population growth. Niharika, who began working with strays since the early 2000s, points to over 8,000 sterilizations conducted in and around Powai with support from the NGOs and private vets. "We estimate that 90 percent of the community dog population here has been sterilized," she explains.

This figure directly challenges the popular perception that stray numbers are rising unchecked. What complicates matters, however, is the regular abandonment of furries. "Every year, 30 to 35 abandoned dogs are left behind, sometimes even puppies in sacks," Niharika shares. "That's the vacuum effect; the gap does not emerge from uncontrolled breeding."

Some critics argue that sterilization is cruel. Niharika offers a different perspective: "The mating process in dogs isn't intimate, it's purely biological. A female comes into heat only at certain times. Leaving strays in a constant state of arousal is agonising, even cruel. Sterilization prevents that cycle, while also stabilizing populations."

Systems and Community Buy-In

Shalini, who has been active in caring for strays since she was 10, has personally facilitated over 350 dog procedures and more than 700 animal cases overall. She emphasizes the importance of records and follow-up. "We maintain updates digitally. There's scope to develop apps where every feeder can log surgeries and treatments, which would bring even more transparency," she says.

Her work spans beyond dogs; she's coordinated similar programs for cats in IIT Powai fish markets with the support of vendors. "It took years of persistence, but once locals saw consistency and honesty, support grew," Shalini recalls.

The collective also supplements BMC's efforts with private interventions, bearing costs that can be 10 times higher. Post-operative care is another challenge: treated dogs require antibiotics, rest, and recovery space before returning to the streets. "We personally put in the time, space, and resources, coordinating with vets and volunteers to provide follow-up care," Niharika notes.

A Question of Coexistence

While Feed the Soul's work shows measurable outcomes, it also highlights the limits of volunteer-driven efforts without stronger systemic support. Emotional burnout, funding gaps, and abandoned pets make the work more complex than it seems.

Yet, members insist their efforts are not about affection for dogs alone, but about coexistence in urban settings. Sterilized, vaccinated and well-fed strays, they argue, are calmer, healthier, and pose fewer risks of aggression.

As Shalini puts it, "These animals have lived here for generations. The law already supports the Animal Birth Control (ABC) program. Under AWBI (Animal Welfare Board of India) guidelines, the program allows for sterilization, vaccination, and release of street dogs rather than removal, to humanely control populations. Our job as feeders is to minimize risks and help both people and animals to live together in harmony."

And that may be the bigger question for cities today: rather than asking whether animals belong in our shared spaces, perhaps it is time to ask what systems and safeguards are needed so that coexistence becomes not an exception, but the norm.

Back to the roots: how youth are rediscovering traditional food



In a world dominated by fast food chains, fusion menus, and international cuisines, a surprising and heartening shift is emerging where more and more young people are turning their gaze inward, seeking the comfort, authenticity, and wisdom of traditional food. From urban cafés serving forgotten millet recipes to college students learning to make their grandmother's chutneys, the movement is steadily gaining momentum.

This change is not just about nostalgia. It is about health, identity, and sustainability. Many young adults, increasingly aware of the ill effects of processed food, are embracing the nutrient-rich, minimally processed meals that their families once ate daily.

Ancient grains like ragi, jowar, and bajra are making their way back onto plates. Fermented dishes such as idli, dhokla, and kanji are being celebrated not just for their flavour but for their probiotic benefits.

Social media has played an interesting role in this revival. Food bloggers and influencers are reviving traditional recipes in visually appealing ways, sharing the stories behind them, and demonstrating how they can be incorporated into modern lifestyles. Farmers' markets and organic food stores are also enabling access to local ingredients that were once on the verge of fading from memory.

The movement is not limited to rural or semi-urban areas; in places like Powai, young professionals are organising potlucks that feature home-cooked regional dishes, while local restaurants experiment with heritage menus. For many, it's a way of staying connected to their cultural roots while navigating a fast-paced urban life.

Traditional food is more than what's on the plate — it carries the history of a community, the rhythm of seasons, and the wisdom of generations. By returning to these culinary roots, today's youth are not only nourishing themselves but also preserving a living heritage. This trend is a quiet but powerful reminder: the future of food might just lie in the past.

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MHADA 22,23



Lilium - Lantana, Nahar

Photographs and pauses: capturing life between frames



Girija Menon

There is a quiet, almost secret magic in an old photograph. At first glance, it's just a picture—faces frozen, places preserved, light captured in a neat rectangle. But the moment our eyes truly engage with it, something shifts. A connection happens and the years fall away, and we are pulled into a memory we may not have thought about in decades. Somewhere in that faded image lies not just a moment in time, but a portal to emotions we thought had been tucked away forever. Those moments are sadly fading as digital photographs have replaced those in albums and frames. The fading of those snaps also says so much because it has seen the journey of time.

It could be a photograph from a bustling family gathering, where the main subjects pose dutifully in the centre, but in the corner, an uncle is caught mid-laughter, eyeing a plate of samosas dangerously on the edge of a table. Or maybe it's a grainy image of a street your home is located, a rickshaw maybe, or shop with bold lettered name or just a lonely cycle leaning against a lamp-post or wall. They are the very essence of the scene, evoking a world that no longer exists but lives vividly in our minds. That huge tree on the street, or the noisy rickshaw, the honking of the bus and a vendor seeking customers for his wares.

The power of photographs is not only in what they show but in what they remind us to notices, casual random things with did not seem important then, suddenly brings back a flood of memories. . They capture moments we didn't know were significant—our grandmother's hands resting on her lap, the wrinkles and every vein showing through that translucent skin, mischievous glance exchanged between siblings, the way sunlight slanted across a familiar room onto a sofa where you spend so much of time while growing up. In the rush of everyday life, we rarely pause to appreciate these small things. Yet years later, it is exactly these pauses—the unposed, unscripted fragments—that hold the deepest meaning. Personally, for me these pauses come back as clearly as it happened yesterday.

Sometimes, looking at an old



photograph feels like meeting an earlier version of ourselves. There's the child who was taught every dream was possible but had the fears of failure and ridicule, the young adult standing on the edge of an exciting future, yet nervous on if he or she will be as good as expected, the friend's whisper or arm around one's shoulder that gave a sense of comfort and motivation. We recognize them, yet also feel the distance. And that mix—part joy, part longing—reminds us how much we've lived, changed, and grown. Grown to be detached from that life because the present has in a way over-ridden the past.

In our digital age, where we take hundreds of pictures in a week and store them away in endless cloud folders, we risk losing the intimacy of these moments. We scroll past images as quickly as we capture them, rarely giving them the time to breathe. But the old printed photographs—the ones with curling edges and a faint scent of the albums they were stored in—demand us to stop. They slow us down. They invite reflection. Reflections mean so much more with every passing year.

Looking back through them is more than nostalgia; it's a gentle act of gratitude. We realise that life is not made up solely of milestones—birthdays, weddings, achievements—but of the spaces in between. The pauses. The conversations that didn't seem important until the people in them were no longer with us. Too late to connect and make amends.

Between one frame and the next, life unfolds quietly. And one day, when we pause to look back, we understand that these captured pauses are not just fragments of the past—they are pieces of ourselves, patiently waiting to be found again.

What's in today's frame will be the "reflection" when you sit on a couch reflecting. Only change would be you would be scrolling or swiping on a screen and now because there are so many photographs, you literally hit the X and exit the application, until you come back here when you remember something or someone from that "past"



(Girija Menon, the author, enjoys her passion for writing. Her first love is poetry; an astute observer of the world around us, she loves writing down her thoughts in both poems and prose. LIFE THREADS is what she uses to weave this one-of-a-kind fabric that spans reams. She can be reached at – whisperingverses@gmail.com)

Pṛthvī to Ākāśa: The Fivefold Foundation of all Creation (Part 2)

Keeping afloat with Jala Tattva



Palak Sardana

Indra, the rain God was considered the most significant deity in the early Vedic period with the Rigveda dedicating maximum hymns to him (close to 250) than any other deity. The reason was the rain dependent nature of the then agrarian society. In an avant-garde, poetic expression, Indra using his thunderbolt, slayed the demon Vrtra (the withholder of water/moisture heavy clouds) releasing the rain to fall and nourish the earth.

The role of water (jala tattva) in the survival of all life forms on the planet is undisputable. The strongest theories supporting genesis of life indicate that life originated in the deep waters of the oceans. In Lord Vishnu's Dashavtara tradition, his first manifestation on the planet is considered to be that of 'matsya' (fish), syncing with the theory of life's origin in water.

Just as water covers nearly 70% of the Earth's surface, human body too is largely dominated by the water element, varying anywhere between 55–70%, depending upon an individual's age and state of health. Ayurveda classifies the composition of human body into seven fundamental constituents (saptadhatus). These constituents nourish, grow and support the body with the help of food as fuel. Jala tattva is either a primary or secondary element in six of the seven dhatus except for asthi (bone). Rasa (plasma), majja (bone marrow) & shukra (reproductive fluids) are most influenced by jala tattva while rakta (blood) mamsa (muscles) & meda (adipose tissue) have the secondary support of water element. Most of the water element is stored in plasma, lymph, cerebrospinal fluid, and intercellular spaces.

Last few decades have witnessed a growing trend in emphasising 'adequate' water consumption and rightfully so as water is essential to carry out various physiological processes from digestion to transport of nutrients, temperature regulation, and waste elimination. Even mild dehydration can cause fatigue, headaches, impaired cognitive function (73% of brain is water) & deterioration in physical performance.

The popular belief is to drink anywhere between 2-3 litres of water per day. But this isn't accurate and shouldn't be followed blindly since every individual is unique and factors such as age, sex, activity level, state of health and the external environment play a role in determining everyone's customised need. Also, fluids are consumed in surrogate forms via juicy fruits, moisture dense vegetables, stews, soups, dals, hot & cold beverages etc. Hence overall consumption and the external environment both play a role in determining the right balance since both under and over consumption can cause distress.



Wherever the temperatures are unnaturally controlled (air-conditioning or heat) the need for water consumption goes up as dissipation of moisture from the body increases. Dryness of skin, constipation & joint stiffness are just some of the symptoms. The antidote is to keep replenishing the lost fluids by sipping on warm or room temperature water through the day and increasing humidity via humidifiers or indoor plants.

Water is inherently cooling with fluidity & lubrication as its core properties. Hence, hotter climates & aging increases the need for hydration.

Drier skin, stiffer joints, sluggish metabolism and dependence on medication for chronic ailments are some are some side-effects of aging. In order to mellow down their effect on internal systems, water intake needs to be upped. Ironically, this is also the time when the brain's osmoreceptors which are responsible for signalling thirst, become less sensitive failing to give an indication when the body needs hydration. Hence, the elderly might not even register thirst long before they are already on the brink of dehydration. Keeping water handy and sipping it mindfully through the day is something that seniors need to pay attention to.

Water can have distinct effect on mind and body depending upon its temperature while bathing. A warm bath has a calming and relaxing effect on the body and mind and can promote sedation when taken just before sleep time. On the contrary, cold-water showers stimulate both mind and body. They increase alertness and mental sharpness and also make the body ready for action by stimulating production of adrenaline and dopamine.

From oceans to our veins, the water element flows, nourishing body, mind, and spirit in its gentle, life-sustaining dance. The biggest concern today is that we are rapidly spoiling jala tattva's equilibrium in nature due to our greed & lack of discernment. Melting glaciers, rising sea levels & unanticipated flash floods are all prelude to self-created circumstances of annihilation.

If we do not sift our needs from wants and greed, we will deplete all drinkable water resources which are just 1% of planets' total water resources.

Water conservation isn't activism—it's survival, and needs urgent action. What are you ready to do at your level? Email your thoughts to the below id.

(Palak Sardana is a Harvard certified wellness coach, a mental health counsellor, yoga teacher & founder of wellness venture, Tranquility Unlimited. Via these articles, her endeavour is to present non-invasive & practical models of wellness grounded in ancient wisdom and modern scientific research. She runs ongoing wellness classes. For joining or booking a personalized consultation/session, write to tranquilityunlimited@gmail.com)

Festivals and diabetes – enjoy without guilt



Nisha Singh

India and Festivals are synonymous. And festivals are synonymous with food. From sweets to savouries and everything in between, Indians tend to express happiness, pleasure, and hospitality through food. And hence it's obvious that with the onslaught of this smorgasbord just around the corner, temptation is going to be extremely high for everyone. Eating right becomes a challenge for everyone, and it becomes more so challenging for people having Diabetes.

Management of Diabetes is primarily all about managing the numbers. Blood glucose levels, HbA1C levels, insulin dosages and carb counting. To maintain these numbers in a good range during festivals requires extra vigilance and effort.

Remember the following to make it easier for you to manage your blood sugar levels during the festivities.

- Portion control - Always remember that festivals are not an excuse to over - indulge. Make it an occasion to indulge but responsibly. Portion control becomes one of the key factors in managing diabetes during festivals. Taste everything, feast minimally. Use smaller plates. Avoid foods that are rich in refined flour, deep fried or are processed. Make smart eating choices. If you want to enjoy a fried food, ensure that you pair it with a good portion of either salad or whatever protein sources are in the spread, Opt for smaller portions. Cut mithais into smaller pieces so that you can enjoy them slowly and for a longer period of time.

- Balance the plate - When you pick up the plate during parties or festival get togethers, remember to balance the plate. Only one fourth of your plate must include carbs like wheat, rice, or even healthier options like millet or quinoa. The other one fourth must include protein like dals, legumes, dairy items, or eggs, chicken etc. Next one fourth must be filled with salads or veggies. And the last one fourth should remain empty. It is important to leave some space empty in the stomach and hence the plate to efficiently digest all that rich festival food.

- Hydration - The most ignored aspect during festivals is consuming enough water. Adequate consumption of water becomes all the more important for diabetics since dehydration increases the blood sugar levels sending your glucose numbers out of range. Furthermore, inadequate water intake stresses the kidneys and impairs their functioning. Kidneys are the organs that help flush out the excess glucose from the system. On the other hand it is equally consequential to remember not to swap plain water with sugary drinks, alcohol or even coffee. After plain water, good choices would be infused water, herb teas - like cinnamon, fennel or ginger steeped ones, and lemon water.

- Don't skip meals - Many people tend to avoid eating before a party, thinking that this will give them more leeway in



managing their meals. The thought is that they will be able to indulge more. In fact the smart plan is to never attend a party on an empty stomach. Neither for indulgence nor for health. Light headedness related to low blood sugar is a very real risk factor amongst the diabetics. On the flipside, always step out after having a small snack. Preferable choices can be a handful of mixed nuts, small bowl of sprouts or makhana, peanut chaat or a glass of buttermilk.

- Sleep is important - Festival time can be hectic and chaotic. Late nights and early mornings often come with lots of stress not just physical but mental too. The downside for diabetics is that in stressful times, cortisol which is the stress hormone tends to increase. An increase in cortisol causes an increase in the blood sugar levels as well. And, an elevated blood sugar further increases the cortisol levels in the body. It's a vicious circle which is not impossible to break if one makes careful choices. Prioritise sleep no matter what. This goes a long way in managing blood sugar levels. Do not skip exercise even if it is a shorter duration. If nothing else, ensure that you get in some meditation and pranayama done during the day. This helps in bringing down the stress hormone in the body and leads to better blood sugar management.

- Move - More and more research shows that as little as a minimum of 3 to 5 minutes of slow walk post every meal plays an important role in managing the blood sugar levels. Ideally, the stroll should be for about 10 to 15 minutes. This helps in lowering the post-meal blood sugar increase. Not only that, post meal walks also increase insulin sensitivity thereby preventing sharp blood sugar spikes.

- Mindful eating and fasting - Fasting is an integral part of several Indian festivals, be it Navratri or Ramadan. It is important to plan for your meals before, during and after a fast. Oftentimes when fasting foods are unplanned, when it's the time to break a fast, there is no control over the choices as well as the portion. It is important to remember that ideally fasting for long periods without any snack at all is not ideal for an individual with diabetes. Ensure that meals include a good protein source with lots of vegetables to help balance the blood sugar. When meals are planned, it gets easier to prevent episodes of hyper or hypoglycemia. Also, it is very important to be mindful about eating in general, not only during fasts. Eat slowly and without distractions. Chew well and try to pay attention to the food that you are eating to get the maximum benefit out of it.

Festivals are a time for joy, fun and togetherness. Try to keep the above tips in mind to enjoy and indulge without any side effects. Remember, BALANCE is always the key, the sweetest mithai you can give yourself this festive season.

You can follow Dietitian Nisha on Instagram for nutrition & fitness tips and live interactive sessions at – nurtiwellness.by.dt.nishas

We at My Powai are taking our readers' queries related to Diet & Nutrition, which Ms. Nisha Singh will reply to in our forthcoming issues.

You can send your questions at: dietnutrition.queries@gmail.com

(The writer is a gold medalist in Food & Nutrition with more than 12 years experience. She manages various ailments through lifestyle and dietary modifications and specializes in weight loss & management. She practices at 102, Crystal Center, Raheja Vihar, Powai or Smile Craft, 23, Annapurna Industrial estate, Opp. CCD, Ghatkopar East. For appointments: 022 2857 6537 Email: singhnisha@gmail.com)

Flavors of faith: Odisha's temple kitchen on a plate



Sherry Bhatnagar

In Odisha, food is more than nourishment—it is devotion on a plate. Nowhere is this expressed more beautifully than in Puri's Chhappan Bhog, a tradition of fifty-six divine dishes offered for centuries to Lord Jagannath. From the hearty comfort of Dalma and the cooling simplicity of Pakhala Bhata to the irresistible sweetness of Chhena Poda, each dish carries both flavour and faith. Among them, the golden Khaja stands apart—flaky, crisp, and melt-in-the-mouth, a bite of pure indulgence that lingers in memory. What makes this offering unique is how even the humblest local vegetables are elevated into sacred prasada, embodying the temple's philosophy of purity and surrender. ***This is Part 1 of our 2-part series*** on Odisha's amazing cuisine—celebrated with PURE HEART, PURE INGREDIENTS, POORNA SAMARPAN.



Khaja – Nothing can be better than a crisp, golden and layered, sweet fritter that melts in the mouth to be the perfect beginning to our journey.

Ingredients
For Khaja
1 cup all purpose flour
1 tsp cardamom, powdered
1⁄8 tsp salt
2 tbsp ghee
1⁄4 cup water
Oil for deep frying

For Chashni:
1 1⁄2 cup granulated sugar
1⁄2 cup water
1⁄4 tsp cardamom, powdered

Method of Preparation
For Khaja

- Knead flour, cardamom, salt, ghee, and water into a soft dough. Rest 30 mins.
- Roll dough into thin chapatti shape and trim edges to get a rectangle, Now, roll tightly into a cylinder and cut into 1-inch pieces, then flatten it in oval shape.
- Fry in medium-low hot oil until golden and crisp.

Sugar Syrup Coating

- Boil sugar and water over medium heat to 1-string consistency. Soak fried khaja in the syrup for 5 minutes before serving. Serve or place in an airtight container.
- If deep-frying feels daunting, you can bake Khaja instead. at 180°C for 20–25 minutes until golden and crisp. Then dip in sugar syrup.

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Dalma – Odia Temple-Style Lentil & Vegetable Curry -Dalma is the soul of Odia cuisine—nutritious, sattvic, and offered daily in Puri's Chhappan Bhog. It is Odisha on a plate. A wholesome blend of lentils and local vegetables, it reflects balance, purity, and the Odia way of eating close to nature.

Ingredients
Arhar (toor) dal – 1 cup
Raw banana, brinjal, carrot – 1 each (cubed)
Pumpkin, raw papaya – 1 cup (cubed)
Drumsticks – 1–2 (cut into 2-inch pieces)
Yam (suran) – ½ cup (optional)
Tomato – 1 (chopped)
Turmeric powder – 1 tsp
Ginger – 1 tsp (grated)
Salt – to taste

For tempering
Ghee – 2 tbsp
Cumin seeds – 1 tsp
Bay leaf – 1
Dry red chilli – 2
Hing – a pinch

For Dalma Masala (roast & grind)
Cumin seeds – 1 tsp
Dry red chillies – 2
Black peppercorns – ½ tsp

Method of Preparation
Cook dal with vegetables, turmeric, ginger, and salt. Add roasted spice mix and tomato, simmer, then temper with ghee, cumin, bay leaf, chillies, and hing. Serve hot with rice and lemon.



Alu Potala Rasa
Potatoes and pointed gourd come together in a sattvic, spiced gravy—proving that simple vegetables, when offered with love, turn sacred.

Ingredients
2 medium potatoes (cubed)
4–5 potala / pointed gourd (peeled, cut into halves)
1 tsp cumin seeds
1 tsp ginger paste
½ tsp turmeric powder
1 tsp cumin-coriander powder
1–2 dry red chillies
1 tbsp ghee or mustard oil
Salt to taste

Method of Preparation
Temper cumin & red chillies in ghee, add spices and ginger paste, then sauté potatoes and potala. Cook with water till soft, finish with ghee, and serve hot with rice

(Sherry Bhatnagar is the founder of Anubhuti Food Ventures — a passionate food visionary, avid traveller and wellness advocate. With a deep-rooted belief that food is one of the purest expressions of care, she champions traditional Indian flavours, forgotten recipes, and nourishing meals. Through her writing, she invites readers to rediscover the emotional and cultural richness of home-cooked food, and the timeless wisdom that simmers in every regional dish.)

September 2025



Richa Pathak

Aries (Mar 21 - Apr 19): Your focus in September is on transformation. Let go of what no longer serves you, and embrace new opportunities with both hands. It's a time to slow down and evaluate your choices carefully. Trust your instincts when it comes to big decisions. A mentor or guide may appear to help you find clarity in your professional journey. **Lucky Color:** Scarlet Red. **Lucky Day:** Monday. **Remedy:** Take a ritual bath with saltwater on the first Sunday of the month. Visualize yourself shedding old limitations while soaking in the water, allowing your energy to reset and embrace new beginnings.

Taurus (Apr 20 - May 20)
This month is about patience. In relationships, take your time and evaluate connections carefully. Financially, avoid making impulsive investments. You'll be able to assess things clearly if you trust your gut. Your inner strength will be your greatest ally in navigating the complexities of this month. **Lucky Color:** Earthy Brown. **Lucky Day:** Wednesday. **Remedy:** Bury a coin under a healthy tree to anchor your financial growth and increase long-term stability.

Gemini (May 21 - Jun 20)
September brings a focus on your ability to communicate. Expect conversations to challenge your beliefs. Approach them with openness and curiosity. Professionally, you may find yourself influencing others with your words, but be mindful of your fears in relationships. Face them head-on before they fester. **Lucky Color:** Electric Blue. **Lucky Day:** Thursday. **Remedy:** Sit in a quiet space and write down your thoughts in a journal every evening to release any mental tension and improve clarity in communication.

Cancer (Jun 21 - Jul 22)
Personal growth is the theme this month. There may be opportunities to step into new ventures, but be cautious of emotional reactions. Embrace change but keep your feet grounded. This is the time for deep introspection and nurturing your soul. **Lucky Color:** Silver. **Lucky Day:** Tuesday. **Remedy:** Place a silver ring in the moonlight on a full moon night to absorb positive lunar energy, increasing confidence and emotional healing.

Leo (Jul 23 - Aug 22)
Ambitions are heightened this month, but the key is to channel your energy wisely. Creative ideas will flow, but they require focus. In love, there may be shifts in expectations. Stay grounded in your values, and be open to change in relationships. **Lucky Color:** Gold. **Lucky Day:** Sunday. **Remedy:** Take a warm bath with rose petals and honey to promote relaxation and creativity, opening the channels for successful ideas.



Virgo (Aug 23 - Sep 22)
Embrace spiritual growth and self-care. This month calls for reflection on your emotional and mental health. Let go of anything that's been holding you back. Pay attention to your routine, as small improvements will lead to big results. **Lucky Color:** Olive Green. **Lucky Day:** Friday. **Remedy:** Drink a glass of warm water with a pinch of turmeric each morning to clear mental fog and enhance clarity.

Libra (Sep 23 - Oct 22)
Focus on collaboration and team efforts. This month, working with others will bring success. Be mindful of the people you choose to work with, as harmony is key. Professionally, partnerships can flourish if you stay diplomatic and open. **Lucky Color:** Lavender. **Lucky Day:** Thursday. **Remedy:** Light a lavender-scented candle during your work hours to increase harmony in team dynamics and attract cooperative energy.

Scorpio (Oct 23 - Nov 21)
September invites you to lead from behind. Use your influence wisely, but avoid controlling situations. Professionally, a shift may unsettle you, but trust that hidden rewards are on the way. Protect your energy from draining individuals in both work and personal life. **Lucky Color:** Deep Red. **Lucky Day:** Monday. **Remedy:** Keep a rose quartz crystal in your workspace or near your bedside to promote emotional healing and encourage productive, loving energy.

Sagittarius (Nov 22 - Dec 21)
Travel and adventure are on your horizon, but it's important to make sure they align with your long-term goals. Don't let impulsiveness drive your decisions. This is a time for learning, whether through travel, study, or spiritual guidance. **Lucky Color:** Bright Yellow. **Lucky Day:** Friday. **Remedy:** Hold a sunstone in your hand for 10 minutes each morning to bring vitality and clarity to your travels and learning pursuits.

Capricorn (Dec 22 - Jan 19)
Focus on creating strong foundations this month. Financially and emotionally, you'll need to make decisions that will shape your future. Slow and steady wins the race, but be mindful of any karmic debts that need addressing. **Lucky Color:** Charcoal Grey. **Lucky Day:** Saturday. **Remedy:** Offer a handful of salt to flowing water to cleanse past energy and create space for new opportunities in your life.

Aquarius (Jan 20 - Feb 18)
This month, focus on contracts, commitments, and personal relationships. Before making decisions, pause and reflect. A personal relationship may reach a significant turning point. Be mindful of compromises, as they will have long-term implications. **Lucky Color:** Sky Blue. **Lucky Day:** Wednesday. **Remedy:** Sleep with a piece of amethyst under your pillow to enhance intuition and provide mental clarity when making career decisions.

Pisces (Feb 19 - Mar 20)
Your intuition will be strong this month, guiding you toward spiritual growth. You'll feel a need to nurture your inner self and focus on healing. Pay attention to the small details in your daily routine, as they'll lead to profound shifts. **Lucky Color:** Aqua. **Lucky Day:** Sunday. **Remedy:** Meditate near a body of water, like a lake or river, to synchronize your energy with the flow of life and receive divine insights.

(Astrologer Richa Pathak masters the art of Astrology, Vastu & Numerology. In-person consultation with prior appointment can be done at 207, Lantana, Nahar Amrit Shakti, Chandivali, Powai. She also gives Virtual Consultation & can be reached @ 8452920640 & www.jyotishdham.com)